

DEFENSIVE COMPACTNESS

06-P9 | Function — TouchTight Coaching | Arrow Soccer — Defending Unit | Phase 1 of 3

Area 50 x 40 yds • **Shape** 343 defensive unit

Focus Preventing penetration in the final third

Numbers Defensive unit v 4 attackers + pivot

ORGANISATION

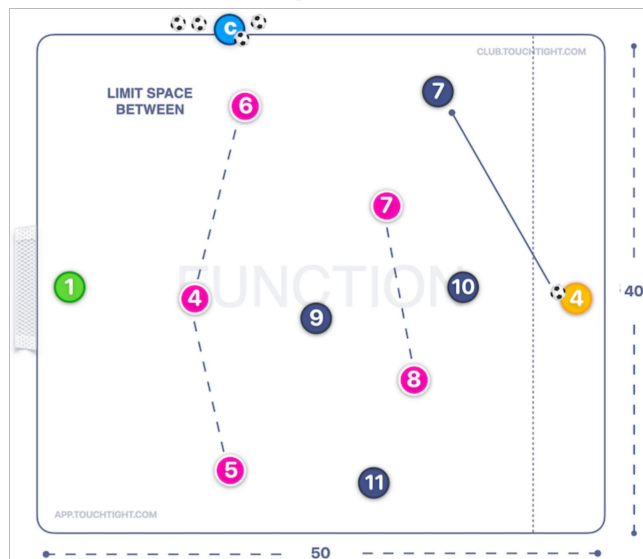
- Functional practice built around a **343 defensive unit**, focused on preventing penetration passes in the final third — especially against an attacking group of four.
- A pivot player sits behind the attacking unit to start play, letting the attackers vary their angles of approach and exploit space.
- Attackers challenge the unit with runs onto balls played in behind, plus short, quick combinations to test organisation and force mistakes.

KEY COACHING POINTS

- Maintain compact positioning to prevent penetration through central areas.
- Communicate effectively between units to cover and support each other.
- Recognise when to press individually and when to press as a coordinated group.

PRACTICE

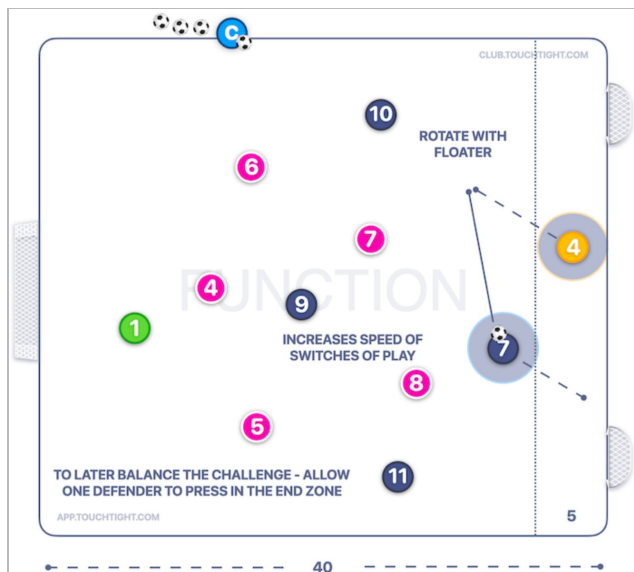
Defensive Compactness



The 343 unit defends the 50 x 40 area against four attackers plus the pivot. Limit the space between the units and keep the ball in front.

PROGRESSION 1

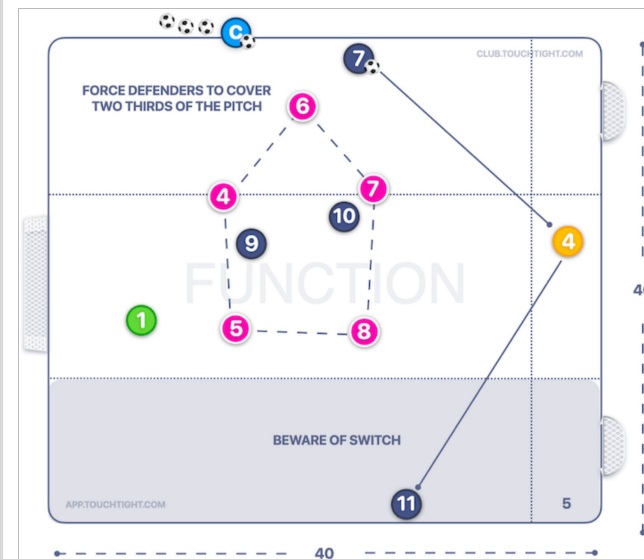
Press in the End Zone



Allow one defender to press in the end zone and rotate with the floater. Increases pressure and forces quicker, smarter play.

PROGRESSION 2

Cover Two Thirds



Force the defenders to cover two-thirds of the pitch, staying alert to switches of play to hold shape and prevent overloads on either side.

DEFENSIVE PRESSURE (BACK 3)

10-P13 | Advanced Lead — TouchTight Coaching | Arrow Soccer — Defending Unit | Phase 2 of 3

Area 30 x 35 yds, three zones • **Shape** Back three

Focus Defensive shape and pressure from a back 3

Numbers 3 defenders v 2 attackers + 1 support

ORGANISATION

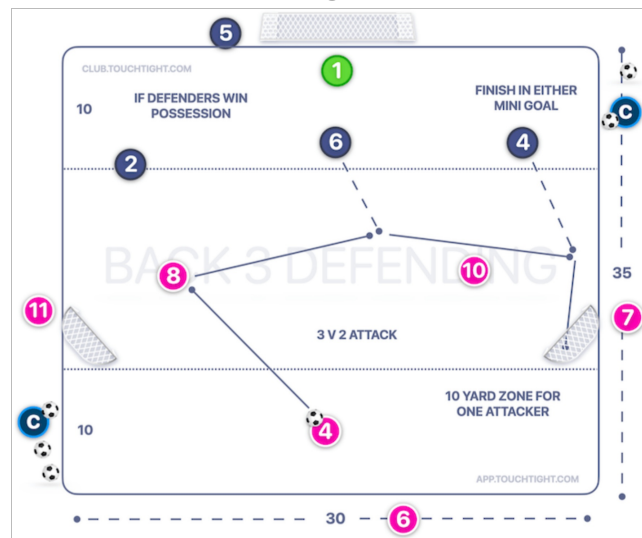
- A 30 x 35-yard area focused on developing defensive shape when set up with a **back three**.
- Three zones: three defenders in one 10-yard zone, two attackers in the central 15-yard zone, one supporting attacker in the other 10-yard zone.
- The supporting attacker passes into the central zone to trigger a 3v2 attack.
- Defenders aim to win possession and finish in either mini goal. Attackers can only use the supporting player twice in an attack before going alone.
- Switch out one defender and all three attackers after every two attacks.

KEY COACHING POINTS

- Stay compact and squeeze the attackers.
- High levels of communication when pressing and covering.
- Shift across quickly to close the gaps.
- Recognise when to apply a high press — know the pressing triggers.
- Patience in possession: draw the attackers in to play out.
- Attackers must recognise gaps and penetrate quickly.

PRACTICE

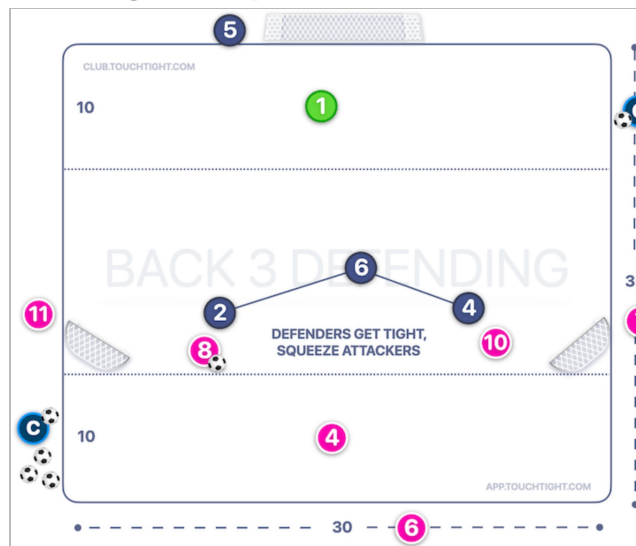
Back 3 Defending



Support player feeds the central zone to trigger the 3v2. Defenders win it and finish in either mini goal.

KEY COACHING POINT

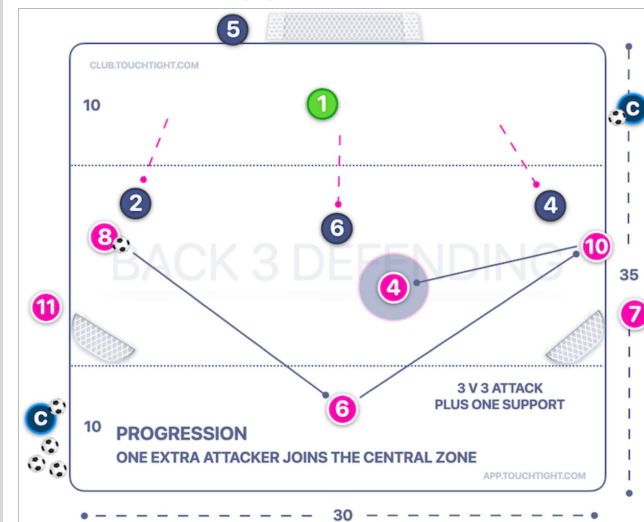
Get Tight, Squeeze



Defenders stay tight and compact, applying pressure to squeeze the attackers — forcing play backwards and limiting options while holding team shape.

PROGRESSION

3v3 Plus Support



One extra attacker joins the central zone for a 3v3, with an additional support player at the base to aid build-up. Defenders must stay even more compact.

DEFENDING OUTNUMBERED

13-P9 | Function — TouchTight Coaching | Arrow Soccer — Defending Unit | Phase 3 of 3

Area 50 x 45 yds, two zones • **Shape** 32 from a 343 base

Focus Staying compact when outnumbered

Numbers 6 attackers (433 base) v our 5

ORGANISATION

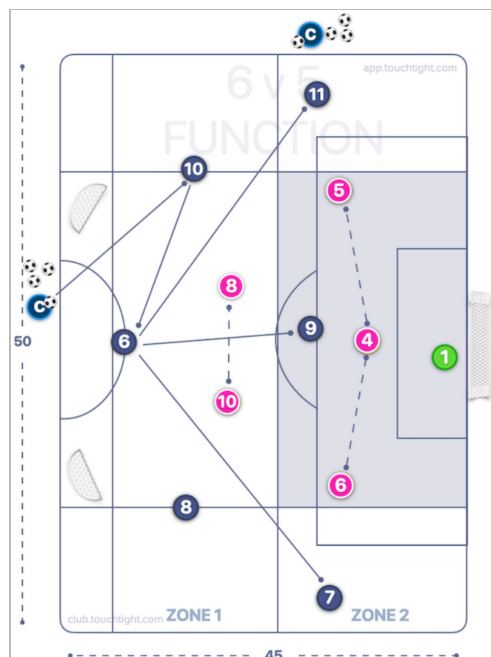
- Focused on the defensive and central midfield unit defending compact when **outnumbered**.
- In a 50 x 45-yard area, six attacking players set up in a 33 (433 base) against our 32 (343 base).
- The objective is for the compact defending five to force play away from goal into wide areas and keep the ball in front of them.
- When they regain it, they finish in one of two mini goals at the opposite end.

KEY COACHING POINTS

- Keep the distances between the back three and the two central midfielders correct — compactness and defensive balance.
- Central midfielders block passes into the opposition's number 9, cutting off the key channels.
- Always force play out wide, directing the ball away from the central goal area to reduce scoring chances.

PRACTICE

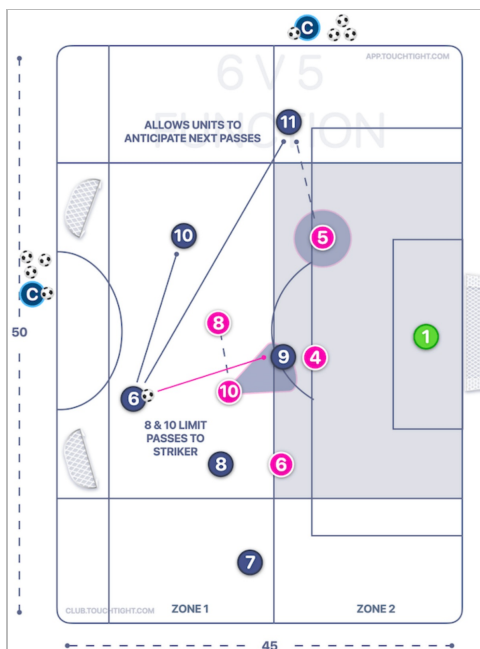
6 v 5 Function



Six attackers against our five across two zones. Force play wide, keep the ball in front, and finish in the mini goals on the regain.

KEY COACHING POINT 1

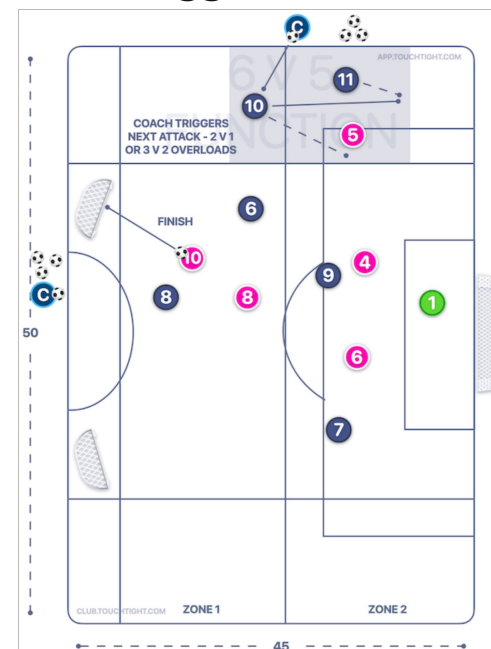
Block the Striker



Midfielders 8 and 10 stay compact to block passes into the striker and force direction, letting the unit anticipate play and intercept.

KEY COACHING POINT 2

Overload Triggers



Coach triggers the next attack with a 2v1 or 3v2 overload, creating numerical advantage and forcing quick decisions under pressure.